

Review Writing Example 2



Inception

Captivating, Breathtaking and Mind-Boggling Rating: ★★★★★

Inception is like no other film you will see this year. It is almost impossible to fit it perfectly into a genre and in fact, that is part of its charm. This film is thrilling, clever and intellectual, forcing the viewer to consider morals, impossibility and the limitations of life. As you are wrapped in layer upon layer of dream, you will undoubtedly ask yourself: how safe are my dreams?

The film follows Dom Cobb (Leonardo DiCaprio) and his dangerous team of mind thieves who can infiltrate dreams and manipulate the subconscious. Although an immoral career choice, it is one that is extremely lucrative; however, it has also cost Cobb his family. With an opportunity to be returned to the life and domestic bliss that he longs for, Cobb agrees to one final job and employs apprentice Ariadne (Ellen Page) to help, along with his usual associates, including Arthur (Joseph Gordon-Levitt). As they journey through layers of the subconscious mind of their victim, the group find they are dealing with much more than the thoughts of their prey: Cobb has his own subliminal battle to fight, but it could destroy all of them.

DiCaprio is nothing less than impressive in this film. His maturing years have brought a grittiness and emotional believability to his roles that have previously been unseen. As Cobb fights with his own personal demons during the extraction, DiCaprio elicits sympathy from the audience despite his illegal actions. Similarly, Page, who has previously

starred in *Juno*, demonstrates a much more mature and complex character than her previously comical roles have allowed. As a sidekick and support to Cobb, Ariadne is a character that is able to be the vehicle for the audience to understand how the complex reality of *Inception* works and also though her eyes see the difficulties that are faced by Cobb as part of the routine.

The visual effects within the movie are stunning: for example, a New York street is magically bent and subverted as part of the inception process, giving the audience a feel for the boundless nature of dreams and the possibility that they can offer. Director and writer Christopher Nolan weaves a magical world for the audience that is simply breathtaking and one that will remain with them long after they leave the movie theatre.

An issue with the film is the complexity of the narrative. Audiences will need to watch the film at least a couple of times to understand the story and even then, the narrative is deliberately illusive and layered, leaving the audience with questions, especially because of the ambiguous ending that leaves the audience to decide the fate of Cobb.

Overall, if you want a film that leaves you thinking, watch *Inception*, but you might want to take notes if you want to find answers to those all-important questions that the film poses.

